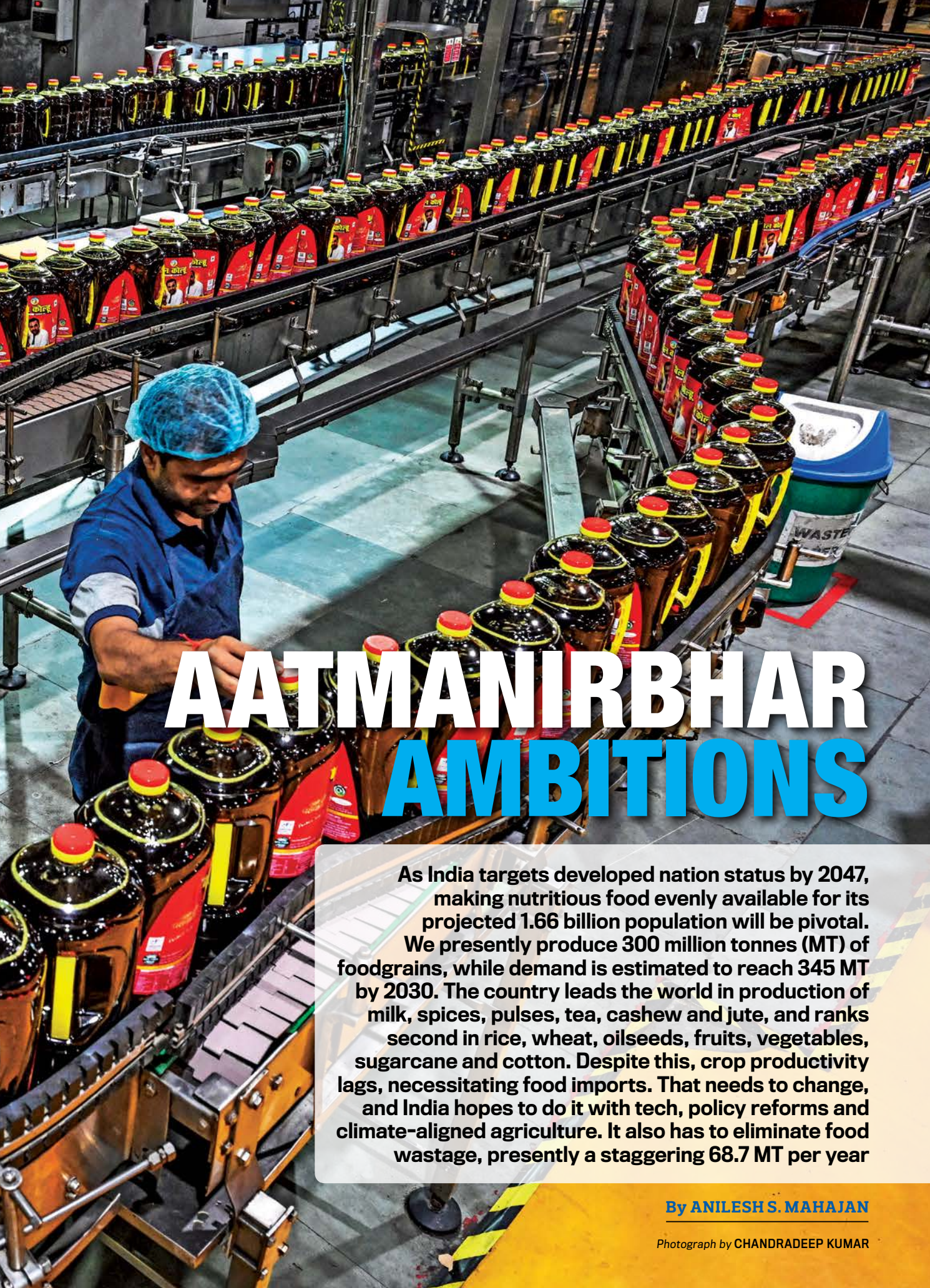


AATMANIRBHAR AMBITIONS

As India targets developed nation status by 2047, making nutritious food evenly available for its projected 1.66 billion population will be pivotal. We presently produce 300 million tonnes (MT) of foodgrains, while demand is estimated to reach 345 MT by 2030. The country leads the world in production of milk, spices, pulses, tea, cashew and jute, and ranks second in rice, wheat, oilseeds, fruits, vegetables, sugarcane and cotton. Despite this, crop productivity lags, necessitating food imports. That needs to change, and India hopes to do it with tech, policy reforms and climate-aligned agriculture. It also has to eliminate food wastage, presently a staggering 68.7 MT per year

By ANILESH S. MAHAJAN

Photograph by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR